

SORTDESK

Week 5 Progress Report

Squad Hunza | Comeback Pakistan Cohort 1

Overview

Week 5 was focused on strengthening the backend foundation of Sortdesk. The team moved past initial setup and into the core engineering work that the entire product depends on: secure authentication with Gmail, and the automation workflows that will power email classification, prioritization, and drafting. This week's work was less visible on the surface but critical underneath everything the dashboard will later present to the user.

Backend Architecture and Automation Workflows

The team dedicated this sprint to building out the backend architecture that Sortdesk runs on. This included structuring the codebase into clear modules (auth, Gmail integration, email processing, tasks) so that each workflow can be developed, tested, and scaled independently. Alongside the architecture, the team began building the automation workflows that form the core intelligence layer of the product, the logic that will eventually let Sortdesk read, understand, and act on a recruiter's inbox without manual effort.

Google Authentication and Security

A major milestone this week was completing the Google authentication flow end to end. The team implemented OAuth 2.0 login, secure handling of access tokens and refresh tokens, and the encryption required to keep sensitive credentials safe at rest. This was not just a functional integration, it was built with security as a first-class requirement.

The team went a step further by designing and testing the authentication architecture specifically to resist common vulnerabilities, rather than treating security as an afterthought. Given that Sortdesk will have direct access to a recruiter's Gmail inbox, this groundwork was treated as non-negotiable before any further feature work could be trusted to sit on top of it.

Email Processing Workflows

With authentication in place, the team built out the first set of automation workflows that give Sortdesk its core value:

- Email classification, sorting incoming candidate emails into meaningful categories automatically.
- Priority handling, detecting which emails need urgent attention versus which can wait.
- Email drafting, generating a first-pass reply the recruiter can review and approve.

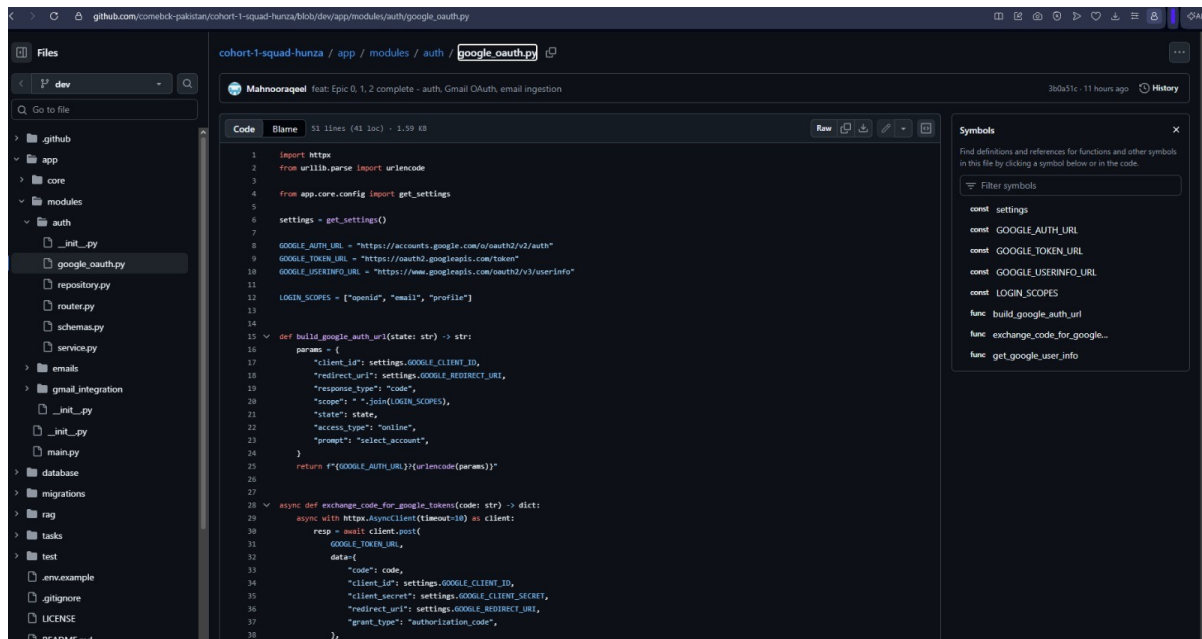
- Duplicate question detection, recognizing when a candidate is asking something that has already been answered.
- Resume extraction, pulling structured, usable information out of attached resumes.

Each of these workflows represents a distinct piece of the recruiter's daily manual effort that Sortdesk is designed to remove. Building them in parallel this week means the product is no longer just a concept, it is a working pipeline that touches a real inbox.

Version Control and Team Collaboration

Strong engineering only works when the team behind it stays in sync, and this week the squad treated version control as seriously as the code itself. Every push to the repository was reviewed and discussed in frequent team check-ins before being merged, keeping the codebase clean and every member aware of what was changing and why.

The screenshot below is a real snapshot from the Sortdesk GitHub repository, the Google OAuth module built and shipped this week, with a clear commit history showing exactly who built what.

A screenshot of a web browser displaying the GitHub repository for Sortdesk. The repository is 'comeback-pakistan/cohort-1-squad-hunza' and the file being viewed is 'app/modules/auth/google_oauth.py'. The file is in the 'dev' branch. The commit history shows a recent commit by 'Mahnooraqae' 11 hours ago. The code is displayed in a dark-themed editor, showing imports for 'urllib.parse' and 'app.core.config', and functions for 'build_google_auth_url' and 'exchange_code_for_google_token'. A 'Symbols' sidebar on the right lists the symbols found in the file, including constants and functions.

google_oauth.py — Sortdesk repository, dev branch (github.com/comeback-pakistan/cohort-1-squad-hunza)

This discipline around commits and reviews is what keeps the project auditable and collaborative rather than a black box owned by one person. Every squad member's contribution is visible in the repository's history, which is exactly the kind of public, verifiable proof of work this program is built around.

Looking Ahead

With authentication, security, and the core email workflows now in place, Week 6 shifts focus to connecting these pieces into a working dashboard experience and continuing the RAG-based chat assistant, moving Sortdesk closer to something a real recruiter can open and use end to end.